

Announcement

August 31, 2025

FOR CONGREGATION SERVICE COMMITTEES

1. **2026 International Conventions:** We are pleased to inform you that the Governing Body has given approval for 19 international conventions to be held during the 2026 convention season.

2. We ask that you become familiar with the direction provided in this announcement and in *Instructions for Applying to Attend an International Convention* (CO-151). In particular, the congregation secretary (or another elder assigned to assist him) should understand all aspects of this arrangement. Exemplary publishers assigned to your congregation may be invited to apply with a travel group from another congregation in the branch territory. Understanding this arrangement will allow you to assist applicants and delegates throughout the process.

- (1) **Applicant Requirements:** Carefully review the information under the headings “Applicant Requirements” and “Explanation of Applicant Requirements” in the applicant instructions. The applicant instructions are also included with the online application.
- (2) The applicant instructions state: **“Do not apply to be a delegate if you have serious health problems, are unable to stand or walk for long periods, require the use of a wheelchair, or have other mobility issues.”** In the past, delegates have required hospitalization and, in rare cases, have died while attending an international convention. Although health problems can arise unexpectedly, even seasoned travelers experience stress when visiting areas with a different temperature, climate, or environment. In their desire to experience an international convention, marginally healthy brothers and sisters might make decisions that are not in their best interests. That is why we ask that you carefully evaluate all applicants based on the requirements outlined in the applicant instructions. Only publishers who meet the requirements should be approved by you to apply as delegates. If an applicant does not meet the requirements, please kindly explain to him the reason why his application will not be forwarded to the branch office.
- (3) Concerning the age requirements for delegates, the applicant instructions state that children between 12-18 years of age as of January 1, 2026 may accompany their parent(s) who are approved delegates. The instructions also state that applicants who are 18 years of age or older as of January 1, 2026 and are serving as either an elder, ministerial servant, or in full-time service may apply. It is possible that a brother or sister between 18-22 years of age may be living at home and not be a ministerial servant or full-time servant, and yet still be an exemplary, baptized publisher. If a request is made for this adult child to accompany the parent(s) to the international convention, you may contact the Service Department to request an exception.
- (4) The secretary should provide applicants with an electronic or a printed copy of *Instructions for Applying to Attend an International Convention*. An application must be submitted for each person, even if he will be traveling as part of a group. Applications should be completed and then submitted to the Congregation Service Committee as soon as possible but **no later than Thursday, October 9, 2025.**
- (5) **Use of JW Hub:** The *Application to Attend an International Convention* (CO-152) will be submitted using the My Applications feature on JW Hub. The secretary should inform potential applicants how they may access the online application on JW Hub. If

a potential applicant does not have a jw.org account, see *Instructions for Congregation Use of JW Hub* (S-135), paragraphs 8-9. A qualified brother should be assigned to assist publishers with the technical details of submitting this online application.

- (6) **Travel Groups:** If two or more applicants plan to travel together (including marriage mates, family members in the same household, or friends), they must form a travel group. For details, see the information under the heading "Travel Groups" in the applicant instructions.
- (7) **Delegate Selection:** The branch office will review all applications that are submitted using the Review Applications feature on JW Hub. Please do not contact the branch office to inquire if an applicant has been selected. The "Status Summary" information on JW Hub will indicate the applicant's status as either "Submitted" or "Selected." Congregations will be informed by the branch office once the delegate selection process has been completed.
- (8) Applicants can view the status of their application in the My Applications feature on JW Hub. Applicants who are selected as delegates will receive an email informing them that they have been selected. It will show them how to access the "My Trip" page on JW Hub, which includes the dates of the international convention, instructions about the list of approved hotels and how to reserve hotel accommodations, what is expected of delegates, and other relevant information.
- (9) **Confirmed Delegates:** A selected delegate will be considered "Confirmed" when he has reserved a hotel room or purchased air tickets. For more details, see the information under the heading "Delegate Selection" in the applicant instructions.
- (10) **Change of Status:** If at any time a selected delegate is no longer in a position to attend the convention, he must update his status on the "My Trip" page on JW Hub. Also, if the person is no longer exemplary (no longer qualifies to apply), the congregation secretary can change the status of the "Allowed to Submit Applications" option in Congregation Persons to cancel the application. The individual will be fully responsible for any financial loss associated with his disqualification as a delegate, even up to the time of departure.
- (11) **Special Rooming:** The host branch office will survey local brothers living in the vicinity of the convention to determine if limited rooming will be available in private homes. If a publisher has requested special rooming and you do not agree that he has a special need, please ask the publisher to resubmit his application. If an applicant who has requested special rooming is selected as a delegate, he will be informed whether special rooming accommodations are available to him (and, if married, his mate). Other members of his travel group must qualify on their own merit to receive special rooming. If a delegate declines private-home accommodations and decides to pay for a room at one of the approved hotels in the convention city, he should inform the branch office immediately so that the special rooming provision can be made available to others.
- (12) **Questions:** As questions arise in the months leading up to the international conventions, a *Frequently Asked Questions* (FAQ) document will be made available to delegates on JW Hub. Delegates may also contact the international convention's Hospitality Committee via email. The secretary may submit questions not answered in the applicant instructions to the Service Department using the following email address: convention.au@bethel.jw.org. Such inquiries will be answered in a timely manner. If an urgent matter arises, please call the Convention and Assembly Desk in the Service Department.

3. It is hoped that the above information will be helpful to you as you render assistance to publishers interested in attending one of the 2026 international conventions. We pray for Jehovah's rich blessings upon all these arrangements.

FOR COORDINATORS OF THE BODIES OF ELDERS

4. **Announcement for Congregations:** Please ensure that the announcement for congregations is read at the next midweek meeting and thereafter posted on the information board.

Announcement

August 31, 2025

FOR CONGREGATIONS

1. **2026 International Conventions:** We are pleased to inform you that 19 international conventions will be held throughout the world during 2026. Our branch has been invited to send delegates to the following international convention(s):

- (1) Taiwan, Kaohsiung, July 3-5, 2026
- (2) Canada, Calgary AB, July 31-August 2, 2026
- (3) Philippines, Manila, October 30-November 1, 2026
- (4) United States, San Diego, November 27-29, 2026
- (5) Thailand, Bangkok, December 11-13, 2026

2. International conventions provide delegates with an opportunity to benefit from spiritual association with the local brothers, not only during the three-day convention but also for additional days before and after the convention. This association allows for “an interchange of encouragement by one another’s faith, both yours and mine.” (Rom. 1:12) To this end, the host branches will arrange for the delegates to share in the ministry with nearby congregations, associate with local brothers at gatherings, visit local places of interest together, and if possible, visit Bethel facilities.

3. After this meeting, the congregation secretary will provide a copy of *Instructions for Applying to Attend an International Convention* (CO-151) to publishers interested in attending an international convention. All applicants should be exemplary publishers who meet the requirements—including age and health—set out in the applicant instructions.

4. In order to apply as a delegate, you must have access to JW Hub. Those who wish to apply but do not have access to JW Hub should contact the congregation secretary. Those who have access to JW Hub can submit an online application by selecting the “My Applications” link. Applications should be submitted as soon as possible, but **no later than Thursday, October 9, 2025**. Please inform the congregation secretary after you have submitted your online application.

5. We trust Jehovah’s rich blessing will be upon all the arrangements in place for the 2026 international conventions.